

# MARKET POSITIONING: Beyond Buzzwords

In a world of imitations, strive for authenticity, connect genuinely, and adapt; that's the essence of crafting a unique, lasting market position. To evolve authentically and emphasise value, here's how to embrace the long game...



**ANAND TAMBOLI**  
is a serial entrepreneur,  
speaker, award-winning  
author, and an  
emerging-technology  
thought leader

**“B**eauty lies in the eyes of beholder,” or so they say.

However, when it comes to a brand, a product, or a company, positioning from a marketing perspective can be much the same. Most marketers will tell you how and why it is important to define a brand relative to competitors. They will tell you it is crucial because it effectively helps your brand or company stand out by highlighting its unique attributes or benefits. It guides marketing strategies, target audience identification, and communication efforts to create a distinct, favourable image. It's a key element in differentiating products or services in a crowded market, ultimately contributing to a brand's success and long-term competitiveness.

Given how important this is for a company and its top and bottom line, market positioning is one of the several critical assets in business.

But that's where most businesses flunk in maximising its true potential.

## Why is that?

Of course, this is the key question—why do businesses falter in maximising the true potential of market positioning?

To me, their lack of understanding and inconsistent implementation are two main reasons to begin with. Most businesses do not fully grasp the intricacies of their target market or fail to understand the needs and desires of their customers. Finding market requirements and user expectations for a product like theirs is rudimentary. But understanding the needs and desires of customers goes a level or two deeper, often resulting in inconsistencies in the implementation of strategies, whether in marketing, sales, or both.

This often leads to ineffective communication and mixed messaging.

There are three key issues that make businesses err and flunk.

## They fail to evolve

For the most part, every business is a momentum game nowadays. Momentum is great when you are on the right path. But it becomes detrimental when there is a market shift, and your direction is wrong.

Whether it is branding, positioning, or simply any product strategy, if the market changes, consumer preferences evolve, your business must evolve too.

